STORMDOM

Global Storm Tracker

Tropical Storm KARINA

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Tropical Storm Karina Discussion Number 40
NWS Central Pacific Hurricane Center Honolulu HI   EP11
Issued by NWS National Hurricane Center Miami FL
1100 PM HST Sun Sep 04 2020

SUMMARY OF 1100 PM HST...0000 UTC...INFORMATION
-----------------------------------------------
LOCATION...21.4N 144.9W
ABOUT 733 MI...1180 KM NW OF HILO HAWAII
MAXIMUM SUSTAINED WINDS...70 MPH...110 KM/H
PRESENT MOVEMENT...NW OR 320 DEGREES AT 9 MPH...14 KM/H
MINIMUM CENTRAL PRESSURE...995 MB...29.39 INCHES

...KARINA EXPECTED TO BECOME A POST-TROPICAL LOW IN THE
TWO...

SUMMARY OF 1100 PM HST...0000 UTC...INFORMATION
-----------------------------------------------
LOCATION...21.4N 144.9W
ABOUT 733 MI...1180 KM NW OF LIHUE HAWAII
ABOUT 810 MI...1305 KM NW OF KAHULUI HAWAII
MAXIMUM SUSTAINED WINDS...70 MPH...110 KM/H
PRESENT MOVEMENT...NW OR 320 DEGREES AT 9 MPH...14 KM/H
MINIMUM CENTRAL PRESSURE...987 MB...29.17 INCHES

...LOWELL BECOMES A POWERFUL HURRICANE AS IT BEGINS TO
WEAKEN...

SUMMARY OF 1100 PM HST...0000 UTC...INFORMATION
-----------------------------------------------
LOCATION...21.1N 145.3W
ABOUT 810 MI...1305 KM NW OF LIHUE HAWAII
ABOUT 887 MI...1425 KM NW OF KAHULUI HAWAII
MAXIMUM SUSTAINED WINDS...70 MPH...110 KM/H
PRESENT MOVEMENT...NW OR 325 DEGREES AT 5 MPH...8 KM/H
MINIMUM CENTRAL PRESSURE...987 MB...29.17 INCHES
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Hurricane LOWELL

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Hurricane Lowell Advisory Number  41
NWS Central Pacific Hurricane Center Honolulu HI   EP12
Issued by NWS National Hurricane Center Miami FL
1100 PM HST Sun Sep 04 2020

...LOWELL BECOMES A POWERFUL HURRICANE AS IT BEGINS TO
WEAKEN...

SUMMARY OF 1100 PM HST...0000 UTC...INFORMATION
-----------------------------------------------
LOCATION...21.1N 145.3W
ABOUT 810 MI...1305 KM NW OF LIHUE HAWAII
ABOUT 887 MI...1425 KM NW OF KAHULUI HAWAII
MAXIMUM SUSTAINED WINDS...140 MPH...220 KM/H
PRESENT MOVEMENT...NW OR 325 DEGREES AT 5 MPH...8 KM/H
MINIMUM CENTRAL PRESSURE...947 MB...27.97 INCHES
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Tropical Depression KROVANH

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...TROPICAL DEPRESSION 23W (KROVANH) WARNING NO 005
NWS TYPHOON WARNING CENTER GUAM MARIANAS
MAX SUSTAINED WINDS BASED ON ONE-MINUTE AVERAGE
WIND RADII VALID OVER OPEN WATER ONLY

WARNING POSITION
---------------------------------------------
090000Z --- NEAR 25.3N 135.8E
            MOVEMENT PAST SIX HOURS...305 DEGREES AT 05 KTS
            POSITION ACCURATE TO WITHIN 030 NM
            POSITION BASED ON ENHANCED INFRARED SATELLITE
            AND PASSIVE MICROWAVE DATA
            MAXIMUM SUSTAINED WINDS...025 KNOTS...046 KM/H
            FORECAST WIND RADIUS OF 34 KNOTS...090 NM...167 KM/H
            REPEAT POSIT: 25.3N 136.2E

FORECAST VALID
---------------------------------------------
091800Z --- 27.0N 136.1E
            MOVEMENT PAST 12 HOURS...005 DEGREES AT 05 KTS
            MAXIMUM SUSTAINED WINDS...025 KNOTS...046 KM/H
            FORECAST WIND RADIUS OF 34 KNOTS...090 NM...167 KM/H
            REPEAT POSIT: 27.0N 136.1E

OUTLOOK VALID
---------------------------------------------
100600Z --- 29.0N 136.8E
            MAXIMUM SUSTAINED WINDS...025 KNOTS...046 KM/H
            FORECAST WIND RADIUS OF 34 KNOTS...090 NM...167 KM/H
            REPEAT POSIT: 29.0N 136.8E
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Hurricane MARIE

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Hurricane Marie Advisory Number  31
NWS National Hurricane Center Miami FL      EP131020
200 AM PDT Sun Sep 06 2020

...MARIE FORECAST TO BEGIN WEAKENING LATER TODAY...

SUMMARY OF 200 AM PDT...0900 UTC...INFORMATION
-----------------------------------------------
LOCATION...15.1N 121.9W
ABOUT 370 MI...595 KM W OF THE SOUTHERN TIP OF BAJA CA
MAXIMUM SUSTAINED WINDS...105 MPH...165 KM/H
PRESENT MOVEMENT...NW OR 315 DEGREES AT 9 MPH...15 KM/H
MINIMUM CENTRAL PRESSURE...971 MB...28.68 INCHES
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Tropical Depression 23W

```
...TROPICAL DEPRESSION 23W (CHANTYTHIRTY) WARNING NR 005
NWS TYPHOON WARNING CENTER GUAM MARIANAS
MAX SUSTAINED WINDS BASED ON ONE-MINUTE AVERAGE
WIND RADII VALID OVER OPEN WATER ONLY

WARNING POSITION
---------------------------------------------
090000Z --- NEAR 29.5N 135.8E
            MOVEMENT PAST SIX HOURS --- 005 DEGREES AT 15 KTS
            POSITION ACCURATE TO WITHIN 030 NM
            POSITION BASED ON ENHANCED INFRARED SATELLITE
            PRESENT WIND DISTRIBUTION:
            MAX SUSTAINED WINDS - 025 KT, GUSTS 035 KT
            64 KT WINDS - 060 NM NORTHEAST QUADRANT
            FORECAST VALID
---------------------------------------------
091800Z --- 32.0N 136.0E
            MAX SUSTAINED WINDS - 025 KT, GUSTS 035 KT
            REPEAT POSIT: 29.5N 135.8E
```

Global Tropics Hazards Outlook

Climate Prediction Center

Week 2 - Valid: Sep 09, 2020 - Sep 15, 2020

Week 3 - Valid: Sep 16, 2020 - Sep 22, 2020

Tropical Cyclone (TC) Genesis Above-Average Genesis Potential Below-Average Genesis Potential Above-Average Genesis Potential Below-Average Genesis Potential

100% - 40% - 30% - 20% - 10% - 0%

Issued: 09/03/2020
Forecaster: Nowicki

Graphic produced by the Climate Prediction Center

See my new article: *How I Met Hurricane Camille*

What Is a Hurricane?

A hurricane (or typhoon, or severe tropical cyclone), the strongest storm on Earth, is a cyclonic (rotary) storm that derives its energy from cloud formation and rainfall, unlike frontal cyclones that derive their power from a temperature gradient.

A hurricane begins as a tropical depression with a sustained wind speed of less than 39 mph (33 knots; 63 km/hr). As the system strengthens, it becomes a tropical storm with winds from 39 mph (34 knots; 63.34 km/hr) to 73 mph (63 knots; 117 km/hr). Storms based in the Atlantic, East, Central and Northwest Pacific, in the South Indian Ocean, and in the Arabian Sea. When the winds are sustained (based on a one-minute average) at 74 mph (64 knots; 119 km/hr), the storm becomes (in the Atlantic Ocean, East Pacific, Central Pacific (east of the International Dateline) and Southeast Pacific (east of 160°E) a **Hurricane**; in the Northwest Pacific (west of the International Dateline) a **Typhoon**; in the Southwest Pacific (west of 160°E) and South Indian Ocean (east of 90°E) a **Severe Tropical Cyclone**; in the North Indian Ocean a **Severe Cyclonic Storm**; and in the Southwest Indian Ocean (west of 90°E) a **Tropical Cyclone**.

The Saffir-Simpson Hurricane Scale

Category 1 – 64-82 knots (74-95 mph; 119-153 km/h). Damage is limited to foliage, signage, unanchored boats and mobile homes. There is no significant damage to buildings. The main threat to life and property may be flooding from heavy rains.

Category 2 – 83-95 knots (96-110 mph; 154-177 km/h). Roof damage to buildings. Doors and windows damaged. Mobile homes severely damaged. Piers damaged by storm surge. Some trees blown down. Considerable damage.

Category 3 – 96-112 knots (111-129 mph; 178-208 km/h). Major Hurricane. Structural damage to some buildings. Mobile homes are completely destroyed. Roof damage is common. Storm surge begins to cause significant damage in beaches and harbors, with small buildings destroyed.

Category 4 – 113-136 knots (130-156 mph; 209-251 km/h). Structural failure of some buildings. Complete roof failures on many buildings. Extreme storm surge damage and flooding. Severe coastal erosion, with permanent changes to the coastal landscape not unheard of. Hurricane force winds extend well inland.

Category 5 – 137+ knots (157+ mph; 252+ km/h). Complete roof failure on most buildings. Many buildings destroyed, or structurally damaged beyond repair. Catastrophic storm surge damage. In the Northwest Pacific, a typhoon that reaches 150 mph (241 km/hr) is called a Super Typhoon.

SAFFIR-SIMPSON SCALE

Category	Knots	MPH	KM/H	Damage
1	64-82	74-95	119-153	Minimal
2	83-95	96-110	154-177	Moderate
3	96-112	111-129	178-208	Extensive
4	113-136	130-156	209-251	Extreme
Super Typhoon	150+	174+	241+	Catastrophic
5	137+	157+	252+	Catastrophic

Storm Surge

Historically, storm surge is the primary killer in hurricanes. The exact storm surge in any given area will be determined by how quickly the water depth increases offshore. In deep-water environments, such as the Hawaiian islands, storm surge will be enhanced by the rapidly decreasing ocean depth as the wind-driven surge moves onshore. In areas with extremely shallow offshore waters, such as the Gulf of Mexico, the storm surge will be relatively small. Because of the counterclockwise circulation around the storm, the largest storm surges generally occur to the right of the storm's track (in the Northern Hemisphere). Storm surge is usually defined as the water height above the normal astronomical tide level. Storm surge is usually caused by the strong onshore winds that the storm produces. The maximum storm surge usually occurs near the time of landfall, when the storm's winds have had the longest period to act upon the ocean's surface. Storm surge is also affected by the shape of the coastline, the slope of the land, and the presence of reefs and barrier islands. Some hurricanes have produced storm surges exceeding 20 feet (6 meters) above normal tide levels. Storm surge is the most dangerous part of a hurricane for people living near the coast. Historically, storm surge has been responsible for roughly 9 out of 10 deaths associated with hurricanes.

Tropical Cyclone Formation

By Jonathan Edwards

Tropical Cyclone Genesis is the technical term for the process of storm formation that leads ultimately to what are called hurricanes, typhoons and severe tropical cyclones in other parts of the world.

This occurs when, in the Northern Hemisphere, the Intertropical Convergence Zone, or ITCZ, shifts northward out of the doldrums and atmospheric conditions become favorable for tropical cyclone formation after about the middle of May.

A series of low-pressure ripples develops within the ITCZ. These are known as tropical waves and progress from east to west. In the late season, they typically shift their movement toward the west-northwest, or even northwest, after crossing 45° or 50° W longitude.

These tropical waves, ideally embedded in the deep-layer easterly flow, contain a northeast wind shift. This is typically referred to as a "convergence", where lines of equal atmospheric pressure are pressed together between the high-pressure ridge to the north and the developing low-pressure system. The divergence that results ahead of the convergence zone gives us a reduction in surface winds in the area of the tropical wave approaches. Gusts up to 25 mph may occur. Sometimes there can be gusts to tropical storm force in stronger waves. There can be spots in no weather associated with these waves, but more often than not, they appear as bands of disturbed weather riding the axis of the wave.

When the wave passes over warmer waters (SSTs), convection and resulting rainfall are enhanced. This greater rainfall is concomitant with falling surface pressures. By the time these pressures fall to 1005mb, it is likely that the northern end has closed off to a southwest wind on the backside of the wave. The forward motion of the wave completes the closure on the northern side of a broad low-level circulation, and a tropical depression has formed.

We often hear that a tropical depression has formed, but conditions are unfavorable for further development. There are two conditions that must be present for the tropical depression to continue its development toward storm status. Subsidence in the middle levels of the troposphere must be overcome. Subsidence dries us down from the warm waters below. In addition, a strong anticyclone directly above the low-level inflow is favorable. As a tropical cyclone is pulling in warm, moist air at the surface, it must also evacuate this inbound flow aloft. This occurs in the upper levels of the atmosphere, where high pressure

facilitates the development of the cyclone by evacuating the flow from the lower levels of the cyclone. Every powerful hurricane has an equally powerful high pressure system over it. At the surface, the air spirals inward in a counter-clockwise direction, rises in the developing center, and spirals out of the top in a clockwise direction. In the Southern Hemisphere, it is reversed: clockwise inbound, counterclockwise outbound.

If the upper-level high pressure system does not remain over the cyclone, it means there is shear ahead. This is a strong jet of air that is blowing directly over the cyclone, ripping the cloud tops off the deep convection. This has the effect of breaking down the whole mechanism. This is known as vertical shear. Vertical shear usually comes from a westerly or southerly direction, and can occur if the cyclone is located in an unfavorable position near a cold front or upper-level low pressure system. Another factor that can interfere with the development of a tropical cyclone is subsidence. Subsidence is the sinking of air. This happens on the edge of an upper-level high pressure system. Subsidence dries out the whole system. Subsidence can also produce a marked temperature inversion, which caps the convection. Subsidence can be very difficult to overcome. The cyclone is on the edge of the hurricane's upper-level outflow, and may have to contend with both subsidence and shear. The effect of shear on a cyclone can range from a failure to develop further to catastrophic collapse of the tropical cyclone's support structure.

Hurricanes have the low-level circulation and the upper-level circulation together, after crossing 45° or 50° W longitude. Before this, there is a mid-level circulation. The mid-level circulation is similar in structure to the low-level circulation, and is critical to the survival of a tropical cyclone that is pressing over 60°W. The low-level circulation can be severely disrupted, or even dissipated, by interaction with land, especially mountainous terrain. If the mid-level circulation remains intact, the cyclone can regenerate rapidly when it reemerges over water, providing other factors are favorable.

Assuming all the ingredients are in place—warm SSTs, upper-level high pressure, and falling surface pressures—the cyclone will develop and reach a point of rapid intensification. It is one of nature's perfect machines. As warm moist air converges toward the circulation center, and is forced upward along the narrower pressures, high pressure aloft evacuates the inflow, which intensifies the inflow of warm, moist air, which in turn speeds the upward motion of air in the eyewall.

Eye formation begins when a tropical storm reaches approximately 65mph, provided conditions are favorable for strengthening to continue. The eyewall begins to make its appearance, usually on the eastern (Northern Hemisphere) side of the center. As the system becomes better organized and stronger, the eyewall contracts from about 200 miles across to roughly 90 miles at this stage. An increase in rotational velocity accompanies the eyewall's contraction. The inflow is spiraling in ever faster as it is evacuated up through the developing eyewall and out by the high pressure outflow structure. The eye begins to appear as a clear spot in the center, as the air here is sinking. The eyewall creates subsidence inside of it, which dries out the eye. Cirrus also produce a feature known as the "moat", which is an area of relatively weak convection situated between the core of the tropical cyclone. The combination of eye and moat can make the storm's core look like a doughnut. The eye can have a diameter anywhere from 10 to 40 miles across.

Tropical cyclones can exhibit a great deal of durability provided that the upper level support remains and the southerly (Northern Hemisphere), or northerly, inflow is present. Here are some examples: In 1998, Hurricane Mitch developed into a supermassive Category 5 hurricane. Nevertheless weakening began when the center moved to a position directly north of Honduras, cutting off the southerly inflow, even though the eye was still over a hundred miles offshore. Later, Mitch maintained its mid-level core against all odds over the mountainous terrain of Central America because he was able to advect moisture from the East Pacific. Reintensification to tropical storm strength was almost immediate after exiting the Bay of Campeche. In 1988 Gilbert hit the Yucatan Peninsula, Northeast Mexico, the Central American Republics, Texas, and Tennessee. Most hurricanes will diminish in strength rapidly after landfall, reaching tropical depression strength by 48 to 72 hours. The main threat from the dying storm is from tornadoes and flooding rains. Gilbert was a classic example of a hurricane or typhoon (in the Northwest Pacific) that maintained its strength for days, and most frequently the strong side of the storm. This is because the forward motion is added to the counter-clockwise punch of the storm. Thus, winds will be greatest on the right side of the storm, the strong onshore flow. This is where the maximum storm surge, flooding, and greatest potential loss of life, will be experienced. After landfall, the circulation's motion over land causes a great deal of turbulence, which results in tornadoes. These are especially likely in the forward right-hand quadrant of the storm's path.

Exposure to upper-level westerlies. Frequently, the ridge of high pressure that keeps the hurricane heading toward the west erodes. In the Atlantic Ocean, this may result in strong upper-level westerlies slowing down and impinging on the northern edge of the hurricane's upper-level support structure. Poleward outflow is restricted. A hurricane can still maintain itself when outflow is restricted in one quadrant. If outflow is restricted in two quadrants, resulting shear can destroy the storm.

After landfall. Tropical cyclones cannot survive over land, since due access to warm SST is removed. A powerful hurricane, such as Hugo, which hit Charleston, S.C., in 1989 can produce life-threatening hurricane force winds over two hundred miles inland. As the storm progresses inland, it can dump a huge amount of rain—sometimes measured in feet. The storm may evolve into a frontal cyclone that continues to cause severe weather. The best example of this is Hurricane Camille in 1969—the strongest hurricane ever to make landfall on the continental United States with winds sustained at 190 mph and gusts well exceeding 200 mph—which roared up the Mississippi Valley and eventually exited off the Labrador Coast. Camille maintained tropical storm strength as far inland as Tennessee. Most hurricanes will diminish in strength rapidly after landfall, reaching tropical depression strength by 48 to 72 hours. The main threat from the dying storm is from tornadoes and flooding rains. Gilbert was a classic example of a hurricane or typhoon (in the Northwest Pacific) that maintained its strength for days, and most frequently the strong side of the storm. This is because the forward motion is added to the counter-clockwise punch of the storm. Thus, winds will be greatest on the right side of the storm, the strong onshore flow. This is where the maximum storm surge, flooding, and greatest potential loss of life, will be experienced. After landfall, the circulation's motion over land causes a great deal of turbulence, which results in tornadoes. These are especially likely in the forward right-hand quadrant of the storm's path.

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